

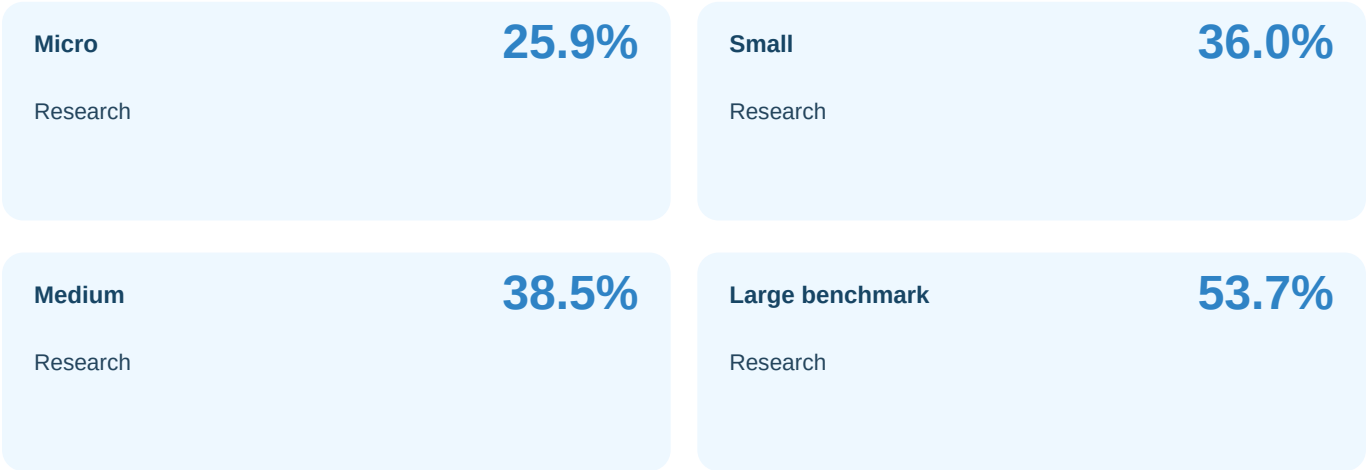
How UK businesses use AI

PRIVATE CANDIDATE - OWNER REVIEW

This report moves beyond whether a business uses AI and examines the purposes reported across seven published use-case categories.

Key descriptive pattern

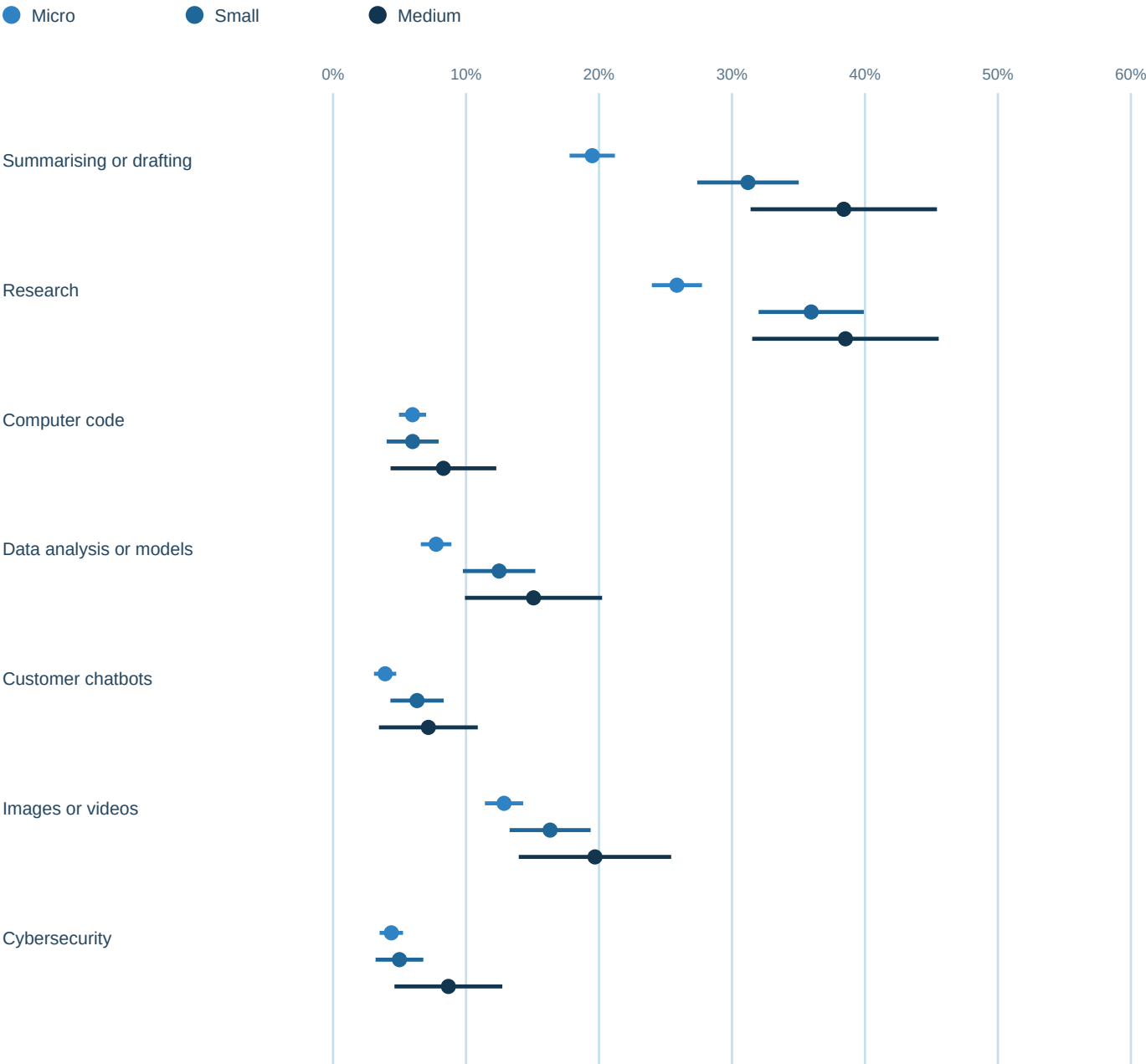
Research information is the highest listed use-case point estimate in each published size group. Summarising or drafting is also prominent. The large-business benchmark is higher across all seven categories.



Important: Table 42 is a multiple-response question. A business can report more than one use case, so the percentages overlap and must not be added together.

Use-case profile for the three SME groups

Point estimates with supplied 95% confidence intervals. These are descriptive comparisons; no pairwise significance test is claimed.



Research and summarising/drafting have the highest point estimates within each SME group. Coding, chatbots and cybersecurity uses have lower point estimates, but the supplied intervals overlap for some comparisons.

Exact estimates and intervals

Percentage of all UK businesses in each published size group. Large businesses are a reference benchmark.

Use case	Micro	Small	Medium	Large*
Summarising or drafting	19.5% 17.8-21.2	31.2% 27.4-35.0	38.4% 31.4-45.4	49.8% 40.8-58.9
Research	25.9% 24.0-27.7	36.0% 32.0-39.9	38.5% 31.5-45.5	53.7% 44.7-62.8
Computer code	6.0% 5.0-7.0	6.0% 4.0-7.9	8.3% 4.3-12.3	19.8% 12.6-27.0
Data analysis or models	7.8% 6.6-8.9	12.5% 9.8-15.2	15.1% 9.9-20.2	30.5% 22.1-38.8
Customer chatbots	3.9% 3.1-4.8	6.3% 4.3-8.3	7.2% 3.5-10.9	20.1% 12.9-27.4
Images or videos	12.9% 11.4-14.3	16.3% 13.3-19.4	19.7% 14.0-25.4	25.9% 17.9-33.8
Cybersecurity	4.4% 3.5-5.3	5.0% 3.2-6.8	8.7% 4.6-12.7	17.1% 10.3-24.0

Rounded unweighted respondent bases

Micro 2,500 | Small 680 | Medium 220 | Large 130

Bases are survey respondents, not business counts. *Large is a benchmark outside the primary SME scope. Intervals shown beneath each estimate are supplied 95% confidence intervals.

How this supports deeper research

A reusable use-case baseline

The seven categories create a general map that can later be repeated for technology, accounting, financial services and other sectors where sample bases and suppression permit.

What the pattern suggests

The point estimates indicate that information work - especially research and summarising/drafting - is prominent across business sizes. This is a descriptive pattern, not evidence of effectiveness or business impact.

What must not be inferred

The categories overlap because businesses could select more than one purpose. Percentages must not be summed. The survey does not measure frequency, quality, productivity, return on investment or causal effects.

Evidence trail

Department for Science, Innovation and Technology, UK Business Data Survey 2026, Table 42. Fieldwork: 10 October 2025 to 28 January 2026. Central estimates, supplied 95% confidence limits and rounded unweighted bases are retained.

Review boundary: candidate F-004 remains private until the complete five-report and website review is accepted.